

4. PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

4.1 Project Goal

The goal is to implement and demonstrate a complete incident lifecycle in ServiceNow, including incident creation, classification, knowledge integration, assignment, escalation, related incidents, emergency changes, resolution, and SLA validation.

4.2 Implementation Plan

Activity 1 – Service Configuration

Configure or identify the required business service/service offering that will be associated with incidents.

Activity 2 – Incident Record Creation

Create a sample incident containing all required information.

Verify that an incident number is automatically generated.

Activity 3 – Incident Classification

Configure/select:

- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority

Verify that the incident has been classified correctly.

Activity 4 – Assignment

Assign the incident to the appropriate assignment group and agent.

Activity 5 – Knowledge Integration

Search for relevant knowledge articles and associate/use appropriate information during troubleshooting.

Activity 6 – Level 2 Escalation

Escalate the incident when it cannot be resolved by the initial support team.

Assign it to Level 2 support.

Activity 7 – Emergency Change

Create an emergency change request when the incident requires an urgent change.

Associate the change with the incident.

Activity 8 – Child Incident

Create a child incident for a related issue and validate the parent-child relationship.

Activity 9 – Incident Resolution

Resolve the incident after completing troubleshooting.

Enter:

- Resolution code
- Resolution notes
- Solution details

Activity 10 – Knowledge Creation

Create a reusable knowledge article containing the solution to the incident.

Activity 11 – SLA and Related Record Validation

Verify:

- SLA information
- Child incidents
- Change request
- Knowledge article
- Other related records

4.3 Resources Required

Platform

ServiceNow Instance

ServiceNow Modules

- Incident Management
- Knowledge Management
- Change Management
- Service Management
- SLA Management

Users/Roles

- End User
- Service Desk Agent
- Level 2 Agent
- Change Management User
- Knowledge User
- Administrator

4.4 Risks and Mitigation

Risk: Incorrect incident classification

Mitigation: Clearly define category, subcategory, impact, and urgency.

Risk: Incorrect assignment

Mitigation: Verify assignment groups before assigning incidents.

Risk: SLA breach

Mitigation: Monitor SLA status and escalate incidents when required.

Risk: Duplicate incident records

Mitigation: Search existing incidents before creating related records.

Risk: Insufficient resolution documentation

Mitigation: Make resolution notes clear and complete.

Risk: Incorrect change association

Mitigation: Verify related records before closing the incident.